

ANI

TAXATION

WHITE PAPER

"Prior to the introduction of the GST, the mélange of state levies, more than 440 tax rates, excise duties and the compliance requirements of multiple agencies meant that India's internal trade was neither free nor united. GST has helped households save nearly Rs 45,000 crore per month from Dec. 2017 until March 2023."

Average tax-GDP ratio

10.5% FY06-FY15

10.9%* FY15-FY24

*Higher despite lower tax rates and widespread relief extended during the Covid-19 pandemic

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"GST is a consumption tax. The poor consume most of their income, while the rich save larger parts of their income. As a result, GST hits the poor more, just like other indirect taxes."

3% Share of the top 10% of the population in GST collections in 2021-22

CORRUPTION

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"The UPA government's decade of governance (or its absence) was marked by policy misadventures and scams such as non-transparent auction of public resources (coal and telecom spectrum), the spectre of retrospective taxation and ill-targeted subsidies and reckless lending by banks with undertones of favouritism."

BLACK PAPER

"PM Modi committed before the G20 in 2016 to lead efforts to 'eliminate safe havens for economic offenders' and 'remove the excessive banking secrecy that hides the corrupt and their deeds'. Instead, he has neutered India's investigative agencies and facilitated the expansion of his cronies into every strategic sector of the economy."

DEMONETISATION & BLACK MONEY

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"We continue to undertake measures to unearth black money and to discourage recourse to it." [Demonetisation finds no mention.]

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"Black money remains, and there's no evidence that demonetisation affected it. The country did not even become cashless."

Cash in circulation (₹ lakh crore)

16 (2016) → 34 (2023)

MANUFACTURING & EXPORTS

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"Our government has made concerted efforts to control the high external sector vulnerability inherited from the UPA government...comprehensive measures undertaken both in the manufacturing and foreign trade space."

Growth in merchandise exports (CY14-CY22)

INDIA 41%

GLOBAL 31%

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"Contrary to the government's PR claims, the share of manufacturing in the GDP has been falling since 2014 and hit an all-time low of 13 per cent in 2022...its share in jobs dropped from 12.6 per cent in 2011-12 to 11.6 per cent in 2021-22."

320% Growth in merchandise exports (CY04-14)

AGRICULTURE

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"The UPA's Agricultural Debt Waiver and Debt Relief Scheme ended up hurting the flow of credit to farmers. In contrast, our Kisan Samman Nidhi strengthened the ability of the farmers to repay their loans. The delivery of welfare is efficient, effective and empowering."

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"Modi government has not taken sufficient measures to address the underlying causes of farmer suicides, such as debt burdens, crop failures.... In Budget 2024, allocation towards PM Kisan Samman Nidhi declined to Rs 60,000 crore from [actual expenditure] of Rs 66,825 crore in 2021-22."

SOCIAL SECTOR

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"Poor policy planning and execution resulted in large unspent funds for many social sector schemes during the UPA years, which in turn crippled their effectiveness.... Empowerment through welfare has been the leitmotif for our government."

Budgeted expenditure left unspent*

2004-2014: 94

2014-2024: 37 (₹ '000 crore)

*Across major social and rural sector ministries

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"Falling incomes at a time of rising costs have resulted in greater hunger. India's position in the Global Hunger Index 2023 was 111 out of 125 countries.... The Modi government's tenure has seen oppression of women, SCs, STs, OBCs."

Note: All charts and figures are based on data mentioned in the two papers